

The number of people temporarily migrating for education is relatively high in districts such as Colombo (12,339) and Gampaha (10,894). Considering the district level, the highest number of people migrating for employment is reported from the Gampaha district (67,844), while the lowest number is reported from the Mullaitivu district (1,215).

Table 5.2.4 : Population Temporarily Living Abroad by Main Reason for Living Abroad and Age Group, 2024

Age (Years)	Total		Main reason for living abroad							
			Employment		Education		Accompanied a family member's need		Other	
	Number	%	Number	%	Number	%	Number	%	Number	%
Total	672,249	100.0	577,919	86.0	53,621	8.0	38,218	5.7	2,491	0.3
Less than 18	19,383	100.0	0	0.0	1,486	7.7	17,862	92.1	35	0.2
18 - 29	187,373	100.0	142,256	75.9	38,053	20.3	6,348	3.4	716	0.4
30 - 59	449,369	100.0	423,249	94.2	14,042	3.1	10,530	2.3	1,548	0.4
60 & over	16,124	100.0	12,414	77.0	40	0.2	3,478	21.6	192	1.2

According to Table 5.2.4, the majority of the population residing temporarily abroad for employment purposes (423,249) falls within the 30–59 age group. Furthermore, 53,621 (8.0%) individuals have traveled abroad for education, with the vast majority (38,053) belonging to the 18–29 age category. Among those under the age of 18, the highest number (17,862) migrated for family-related reasons.

As indicated in Table 5.2.5, the highest percentages of the temporarily overseas population are reported in Kuwait, the United Arab Emirates, Saudi Arabia, and Qatar. Among the male population migrating for employment, the highest proportion (18.3%) was reported in the United Arab Emirates, whereas the highest proportion of the female population (34.3%) was reported in Kuwait.

Regarding migration for education, 24.1 percent of the population migrated to Australia, while 21.3 percent migrated to Japan. The highest percentage of the population who temporarily moved abroad to accompanied a family member's need was reported from Italy.